THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

PMGM7037: Impact Investing in Sustainable Technologies

GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor: Professor Poman Lo
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Consultation times: By appointment between 5:30pm to 6:30pm on May 4, May 18, Jun 8 and Jun 11

Instructor: Professor Stan Ho
Email: stanhohoming@hku.hk
Consultation times: By appointment between 5:30pm to 6:30pm on May 6, May 11, May 13, May 20, May 27 and Jun 15

Tutor: Bill Zhang
Email: billzzha@hku.hk

Pre-requisites: None
Co-requisites: None
Mutually exclusive: N/A

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course introduces graduate students to the field of 'Impact Investing in Sustainable Technologies', an advanced academic course that systematically explores the theoretical underpinnings and practical applications of investing in innovative, sustainable technologies for societal and environmental betterment, promoting critical understanding of risk-return trade-offs, ethical considerations, impact measurement, and regulatory frameworks within the fast-evolving landscape of sustainable finance.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

1. Gain a thorough understanding of impact investing's history, evolution, and future trends, as well as the criteria and analysis of sustainable technologies.
2. Grasp the balance of social/environmental impact with financial returns in impact investing, including risk-return trade-off, assessment tools, and methodologies specific to sustainable technologies.
3. Understand ethical considerations, accountability measures, and the global and specific legal and regulatory environments that impact investing in sustainable technologies.
4. Acquire practical skills for a career in impact investing, enriched by the study of real-world cases of both successful and unsuccessful impact investments in sustainable technologies.
5. Develop an actionable strategy for impact investing in sustainable technologies while understanding the innovative and emerging trends in both fields.

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of the programme discipline

PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge

PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership

PLO4: Developing global outlook

PLO5: Mastering communication skills

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Course Learning Outcomes	Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes

CLO1	PLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
CLO2	PLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
CLO3	PLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
CLO4	PLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
CLO5	PLO4, 5

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	Expected contact hour	Study Load (% of study)
T&L1. Interactive lectures	30	25%
T&L2. Assignments & Projects	60	50%
T&L3. Lecture preparation & Self-study	30	25%
Total	120	100%

Assessment Methods	Brief Description (Optional)	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1. In-class Participation		15%	CLO1, 2, 3
A2. Quiz		25%	CLO1, 2, 3
A3. Assignments		20%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
A4. Group Project		40%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
	Total	100%	

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

Course Grade Descriptors

A+, A, A-	・Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Handling questions professionally ・High participation in discussions ・Present arguments that have an element of originality ・Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the exams with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills ・Excellent performance in assignments
B+, B, B-	・Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Handling questions in a logical way ・Good participation in discussions ・Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook ・Achieve a standard of good performance in the exams with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills ・Good performance in assignments
C+, C, C-	・Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved ・Fairly address questions as set ・Some participation in discussions ・Present arguments in a well-structure manner ・Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the exams with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills ・Acceptable performance in assignments

D+, D	・Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved ・Barely address questions as set ・Minimal or no participation in discussions ・Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner ・Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the exams with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills ・Marginally acceptable performance in assignments
F	・Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved ・Unable or unwilling to handle questions ・Minimal or no participation in discussions ・Present arguments poorly ・Fail to meet a standard of passing the exams with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills ・Poorly performance in assignments
Assessment Rubrics for Participation	
A+, A, A-	・High participation in discussions ・Always attend in-class discussions ・Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Handling questions professionally ・Present arguments that have an element of originality ・Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
B+, B, B-	・Good participation in discussions ・Often attend in-class discussions ・Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Handling questions in a logical way ・Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook ・Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
C+, C, C-	・Some participation in discussions ・Sometimes attend in-class discussions ・Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved ・Fairly address questions as set ・Present arguments in a well-structure manner ・Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
D+, D	・Minimal or no participation in discussions ・Rarely attend in-class discussions ・Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved ・Barely address questions as set ・Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner ・Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
F	・Minimal or no participation in discussions ・Almost never attend in-class discussions ・Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved ・Unable or unwilling to handle questions ・Present arguments poorly ・Behave poorly in class (often chatting with others, using cell phones, or being late)
Assessment Rubrics for Assignments and the Exam	
A+, A, A-	・Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Present arguments that have an element of originality ・Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the assessments with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills
B+, B, B-	・Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge ・Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook ・Achieve a standard of good performance in the assessments with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills
C+, C, C-	・Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved ・Present arguments in a well-structure manner ・Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the assessments with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills

D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the assessments with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the assessments with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

1. Introduction to Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and Sustainable Investing
2. Circular Economy
3. Smart City and Sustainable Transportation
4. Ed Technology
5. Impact Investing in Hong Kong
6. Venture Investing for Good
7. Proptech and Sustainable Living Solutions
8. Impact Measurement and Management
9. AI and Future Trends

The above may be subject to changes depending on the course progress

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS (e.g. journals, textbooks, website addresses etc.)

To be announced on Moodle.

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

○ Online response via Moodle site

○ Others: ___SFTL_____ (please specify)

COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

An orderly learning environment is extremely important for this course. Disruptive behaviors are absolutely unacceptable. Academic dishonesty includes cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, falsifying academic records, and any act designed to avoid participating honestly in the learning process. Any such dishonesty will result in an F grade.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)

Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded on Moodle.

Assignments must be submitted on time in Moodle. No late assignment will be accepted.

Closed book in-class quiz (accounting for 25%) will be conducted on May 27 (Wed). No make-up will be arranged and no alternative arrangement will be made should students fail to attend the quiz.

Group project final presentation will be conducted on Jun 15 (Mon).